

Fifteen minutes of your expertise

A request for critique, not endorsement.

THE PROBLEM

Losing someone is hard enough. What follows is months of administration: probate, inheritance tax, estate accounts, dozens of organisations to notify, statutory deadlines that carry personal liability for the executor. Most people do it once, unprepared, while grieving.

WHY THIS EXISTS

I built AD Assistant while administering a family estate. It is a free, open-source tool for executors in England and Wales: registers for everything, live estate accounts, a deterministic inheritance tax assessment, the official guidance cached and searchable in-app, and drafting that always ends with a human approving. Nothing is ever filed, sent or paid by the software, and no AI model ever calculates a tax figure.

It was built from the published official guidance and one family's experience. That is a real foundation, but it is not the same as seeing hundreds of estates professionally, and it is no substitute for trade experience. That gap is exactly what this page asks you to help close.

It is not legal or financial advice, and it never claims to be. It is the tool I wished had existed, given away so the next family does not start from a blank page.

WHAT THE TOOL DOES

So you can judge from this page alone, this is what AD Assistant currently does. Every claim here is reviewable; if one is wrong or dangerous, that is exactly the feedback wanted.

- **Registers for the whole administration:** assets with a valuation history that distinguishes estimates from confirmed figures, liabilities, money owed to and by the estate, contacts with a who-has-been-notified tracker, costs, documents, and tasks with dependencies arranged on the standard administration timeline.
- **Estate accounts that must balance:** the four-account structure (capital, administration, income, distribution) with an always-visible reconciliation check and live residuary shares per beneficiary.

- **A deterministic inheritance tax assessment**, recomputed whenever a material figure changes: nil rate band 325,000; residence nil rate band 175,000 with the taper above 2,000,000; transferred allowances; the 36 per cent charity rate; the excepted-estates tests; and the rule that claiming the residence nil rate band forces a full IHT400. The required schedules checklist (IHT402 to IHT436) is derived from what the estate actually contains.
 - **Statutory protections built in:** the Section 27 creditor notice window is derived and "safe to distribute" is blocked until it has closed; recording a residential property sale creates the 60-day capital gains reporting task automatically; loss-relief windows (IHT35, IHT38) are watched.
 - **Official guidance cached in-app:** 77 sources (gov.uk, The Gazette, NS&I, support organisations) with source address and fetch date on every document, plus an AI assistant that answers only from that corpus, cites the exact passages it relied on, and ends every answer by saying what the guidance does not cover.
 - **Drafting with a human gate:** notification letters, tax narrations and form content are drafted by AI, but every draft requires a recorded human approval, and the software has no ability to send, file or pay anything. No AI model ever calculates a tax figure; all tax maths is fixed, tested code.
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WHAT I NEED

I am not looking for investment, customers or endorsement. I am asking people who know this domain, professionally or from lived experience, to spend **about fifteen minutes** on one area and answer three questions:

1 What is wrong?

2 What is risky?

3 What is missing?

Blunt is useful. Every point directly improves a free tool for future executors.

PICK ONE AREA

Each area starts from the plain-English user guide, so reviewing the words *is* reviewing the tool's behaviour. Nothing to install, no technical knowledge needed.

The probate process and timeline

PROBATE PRACTITIONER · STEP MEMBER

The tool seeds the standard after-death checklist as ordered tasks, derives statutory deadlines from the date of death, and tracks progress on a timeline. Is the sequence right, are the deadlines right, and are the warnings in the right places?

Inheritance tax and the excepted-estates logic

PRIVATE CLIENT SOLICITOR · TAX ADVISER

The tool applies the thresholds, taper and transfer rules listed above, determines excepted estate versus IHT400, and derives the schedules checklist from the estate's contents. Would you trust its route determination, and where would it mislead a lay executor?

Estate accounts and beneficiary shares

ESTATE ACCOUNTANT

Four accounts, an always-visible reconciliation check, live residuary shares, and interim distributions blocked until the creditor notice window closes. Is the structure sound, and what would a professional preparing estate accounts add or object to?

Bereavement support and tone

BEREAVEMENT ADVISER · COUNSELLOR

A calm, plain interface, and a "When you need help" directory of seventeen support organisations with verified phone numbers. Does the language hold up for someone grieving, and is the signposting right and complete?

Executor experience and clarity

ANYONE WHO HAS BEEN AN EXECUTOR

A dashboard of open tasks, deadlines, money position, tax headroom and outstanding notifications. Where would you have been confused, and what did your administration need that this lacks?

Legal caveats and safeguards

SOLICITOR

Not-advice disclaimers throughout, a professional-review checkpoint on by default, recorded approvals on every draft, no ability to send or file, and a permanent audit trail. Are the caveats sufficient, and what would a cautious professional add?

The user guide and every document referenced here live at the address in the footer; the review guide there links each area to its exact starting section.

HOW TO SEND FEEDBACK

The feedback form (easiest)

A short structured form: which area, what you found, and whether to credit you.

github.com/PaddyGilliland1/after-death-assistant/issues/new?template=expert-feedback.yml

Privately, if you prefer

Message Paddy Gilliland on LinkedIn; nothing you send is published without your say-so.

linkedin.com/in/patrick-gilliland-0b092015

Every point gets read, answered, and either fixed, queued, or honestly declined with a reason. Contributors are credited in the changelog if they wish, or kept anonymous if they prefer.

The project: github.com/PaddyGilliland1/after-death-assistant · MIT licensed, permanently free, no advertising, your data stays yours.

AD Assistant informs and drafts. It is not legal, tax or financial advice, and it is not a substitute for professional help. Its whole design assumes a human decides.